

GENOCIDE

The intentional killing of a racial or cultural group.

GLOBAL WARMING

An increase in global average surface temperature as a result of climate change.

GRAVITY

A force of attraction found throughout the universe.

HALLOWEEN

A celebration on October 31, the evening before All Saints' Day, in which children wear scary outfits and play practical jokes.

HIBERNATION

The dormant, or resting, state in which some animals spend the winter.

HIEROGLYPHICS

A writing system of picture symbols used in ancient Egypt.

HYPNOSIS

A sleeplike condition induced by slow voices or movements. Under hypnosis, people often respond to questions that they might not normally answer.

IMMUNE SYSTEM

The group of organs, tissues, and cells that works together to protect the human body from disease and infection.

LIGHT-YEAR

A unit of distance. One light-year (ly) is the distance that light travels in one year.

LINGUISTICS

The scientific study of language.

MAGIC

The craft of using charms, spells, and rituals that are believed to have supernatural powers in order to control natural forces.

MATRIARCH

A female who rules a family, clan, or tribe.

MATTER

The substance of which things are made.

MENTAL ILLNESS

A psychological state that causes distress or disability.

MORALITY

Beliefs based on the principles of what is right and wrong.

ORATOR

An eloquent and experienced public speaker.

ORGANISM

An individual member of a biological species.

PAGODA

A multi-story temple or other religious building, usually found in the Far East.

PALEONTOLOGIST

A scientist who studies prehistoric life, especially fossils.

PATRIARCH

A male who rules a family, clan, or tribe.

PICTOGRAM

A symbol in the form of a picture that is supposed to represent an object or concept.

PREDATOR

An animal that survives by hunting and eating other animals.

REINCARNATION

The rebirth of the soul in another body or form after death.

SCIENTIST

An expert who adopts scientific principles to pursue a natural or physical science.

SKEPTIC

A person who routinely doubts beliefs and ideas held by many.

SOLAR SYSTEM

The Sun and the objects that orbit it, including the planets and smaller bodies.

SOUL MATE

One of two people deeply compatible with each other.

SUPERNATURAL

Anything that cannot be explained by science or logic.

SUPERNOVA

A massive star that explodes, leaving material behind.

TELEPATHY

The idea that people can directly communicate thoughts and emotions from one mind to another without using the five basic senses.

UFO

Meaning unidentified flying object, this mysterious flying shape cannot always be explained, and some people insist that it is an alien spacecraft.

UNIVERSE

Everything that exists.